

SPAGHETTI ALLA CHITARRA

Pasta, Missy Robbins

REST

20 to 30 minutes at room temperature

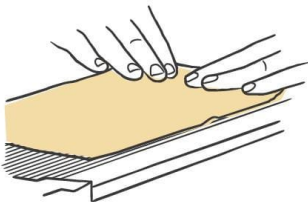
DETAILS

- Dough: egg-dough
- Region: Abruzzo, where it goes by maccheroni alla chitarra, spaghetti alla chitarra, and pasta alla chitarra; Lazio, as tonnarelli

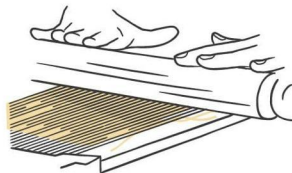
METHOD

1. Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden cutting board lightly with 00 flour. Set out a parchment-lined sheet pan, dusted lightly with semolina.
3. Lay the sheets on the board and cut them into 8 by 9-inch rectangles, trimming off the ragged edges. Save the trim for soup. Keep the rectangles under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Take one rectangle and dust both faces with 00 flour. A chitarra is strung on both sides at two different string spacings — use the narrower side. Lay the sheet over the wires and run a rolling pin back and forth over it, bearing down until the wires cut all the way through. This takes more force than you would expect.
5. Gather the strands, dust them generously with 00 flour, shake them apart, curl the batch into a nest, and set it on the pan.
6. Repeat with the remaining rectangles.
7. Dry 20 to 30 minutes at room temperature. To hold, wrap the pan and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



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NOTES

Requires a chitarra — a tabletop frame strung with fine metal wires, shaped more like a harp than the guitar it is named for, with a collection box beneath. The two faces carry wires at different spacings; this shape uses the narrower one.

Sheets are rolled thicker than usual: 1/8 inch rather than the typical 1/16 inch.

Sheets cut to 8 by 9 inches before going over the wires.

Yields square-sided strands with a springy texture.

One portion at a time is all the tool will do, which is why much of the Abruzzese version is machine-made today.

Keeps refrigerated up to 24 hours.

Interchangeable with spaghetti. Traditionally paired with lamb, either in small meatballs in tomato sauce or as ragù, and with zucchini cooked with saffron.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

OVEN ADJ. _____

NOTES _____
